had played a significant role in the training of the Mukti Bahini for their role in the liberation struggle of Bangladesh but was subsequently dismissed on charges of corruption during his posting as a divisional commander, also moved into the Akal Takht. He started preparing the defences around the Akal Takht in case of an attack on it. Bhindranwale's control over government machinery through fear can be gauged from the fact that the telephone exchange would handle on priority calls made by him and his men.

The final break between Bhindranwale and the Longowal-led Akali Dal was reached when Surinder Singh Sodhi, a member of Bhindranwale's killer squad, was killed on 14 April just outside the Golden Temple complex. Bhindranwale suspected the hand of the moderate Akali Dal leaders behind the killing. Soon, a couple, Surinder Singh 'Chhinda' and his girlfriend Baljit Kaur, were killed for their suspected involvement in Sandhu's murder. In an attempt to reassert his authority, Longowal called a meeting of senior Sikh leaders but found that sixty of the 140 persons who came to attend the meeting had walked over to Bhindranwale's side.

One day before that meeting, Longowal had a long telephone talk with Indira Gandhi. He told her he had lost control of the situation and requested her to make some concessions to enable him to withdraw his morcha. The contents of that conversation were conveniently leaked to the press, further eroding his credibility. In desperation, Longowal contacted five head priests to issue a hukamnama (edict) to Bhindranwale to vacate the Akal Takht. Within days, Bhindranwale got three of his critics, including the former head granthi of the Akal Takht, Giani Pratap Singh, killed to instil terror among the five serving head priests.

Meanwhile, Gurcharan Singh Tohra and Parkash Singh Badal, who had been jailed for burning copies of the Indian Constitution, conveyed their agreement to the withdrawal of their morcha if only Chandigarh were to be transferred to Punjab. As opposed to the earlier stance of the Centre, of requiring the transfer of both Abohar and Fazilka in exchange to Haryana, the prime minister now agreed to the transfer of Abohar only, through an award by a commission, the results of which would be guaranteed in advance. With that